







MEMORIES IN CERAMIC
Clockwise from top left: An untitled, handpainted glazed ceramic tile by Vijoo Sadwelkar; three untitled glazed ceramic tiles by Badri Narayan from the collection of Haresh Mehta

EXHIBITION ▼

A Glass Act

The late BADRI NARAYAN'S vision and Vitrum Studio's quiet legacy take centre stage in a new exhibition in Mumbai

Currently on view at the Jehangir Nicholson Gallery in Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya, *A Glazed History: Badri Narayan and the Vitrum Studio* explores the crossovers of art and design in post-independence India. The short-lived Vitrum Studio (1957–1974) was founded by glass expert Simon Lifschutz, a Jewish war émigré from Poland. The studio invited artists to paint on ceramic tiles and create tesserae (Venetian-style glass mosaics) as affordable art and home décor objects such as coasters, trays, tabletops and lamps.

Modernist painter and writer Badri Narayan was the first artist to join the studio and emerged as its most passionate advocate. He saw the studio as a potential catalyst for integrating art with architecture, fostering "a new national consciousness of art" in the young republic. In line with this thought, *A Glazed*

INTERVIEW ▼

"Working across mediums feels similar"

Artist and photographer SOHRAB HURA has been awarded the 2025 Eye Art & Film Prize by Amsterdam's Eye Filmmuseum

Q. The Eye Art & Film Prize celebrates artists who transcend boundaries between film and visual art. How do you define the relationship between still and moving images in your practice?

When I started photography in the early 2000s, there was an expectation to maintain a consistent aesthetic style to define authorship. But my work has always felt like it came from the same place, even if stylistically different. Making photographs feels like having a conversation, where the tone changes depending on context.

Q. Has this conversational approach influenced how you work across media?

Yes, working across mediums feels similar. I don't begin by choosing between still or moving images. I follow whatever I'm curious about, and let the form emerge on its own.

Q. The jury cited your ability to capture "today's surreal reality". What draws you to these contradictions in contemporary life?

What may seem sur-

"WHAT MAY SEEM SURREAL TO OTHERS OFTEN FEELS ORDINARY TO ME. I TRY NOT TO FIX MEANING TOO TIGHTLY"

